

# BANGKOK

## Airbnb & Real Estate Market Report

*Prepared to evaluate an Airbnb rental / property investment or management opportunity*

Data sources: AirDNA, AirROI, Colliers Thailand, CBRE Thailand, Cushman & Wakefield, Bangkok Post, Thai legal counsel publications

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# Executive Summary

## The Opportunity in 5 Points

- **The same enforcement-driven concentration as Phuket, but sharper.** Active short-term rental listings fell 45.3% year-on-year to 16,437, while average annual revenue per listing rose 138.2% to \$12.5K (AirDNA, trailing twelve months to July 2026). The market rewards listings that survived the cleanup, not new entrants assuming legacy tolerance.
- **Real estate is mid-recovery from a genuine oversupply, not a mature market.** Roughly 58,000 unsold condo units sit across Greater Bangkok. New-launch prices are up 9.4% year-on-year to THB 120,364/sqm even as about 80% of new supply is priced below THB 100,000/sqm to chase affordability-constrained buyers.
- **The same Hotel Act bind applies — enforced hardest exactly where yield is highest.** Enforcement is Hotel-Act-led and concentrated in named tourist corridors: Sukhumvit, Asoke, Phrom Phong, Thong Lo, Ekkamai, Silom, Sathorn. That is precisely where STR demand and ADR are strongest, so the highest-yield zones carry the highest enforcement risk.
- **Bangkok has no meaningful villa/exemption alternative.** Unlike Phuket, Bangkok's stock is almost entirely condominium, so the Certificate of Exemption route that legalizes Phuket villas has no real analog here. 30-day-plus leasing is close to the only compliant income model.
- **Yield is structurally lower than Phuket on every honest comparison.** Central-area gross rental yields run 4–6%, AirDNA RevPAR sits at \$37 versus Phuket's \$94, and STR ADR is under a third of Phuket's. Bangkok's case has to be made on liquidity and foreign-buyer volume, not STR income.

## High-Potential Zones

| Zone                                       | Why It Matters                                                      | Key Number                                                                                                          |
|--------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Sukhumvit / Asoke / Thong Lo / Ekkamai     | Highest STR demand and ADR; also the most heavily enforced corridor | Highest-ADR listings nationally; enforcement sweep covered 191 rooms across several buildings in one 2025 operation |
| Outer Sukhumvit / Bang Na                  | Affordable entry; part of the oversupply discount zone              | Condo THB 80,000–120,000/sqm; steep developer incentives (2–3 years free common fees)                               |
| Downtown / Prime CBD (ready-to-move stock) | Fast absorption despite citywide oversupply headline                | ~93% sales rate on ready-to-move downtown condos (CBRE)                                                             |

| Zone                         | Why It Matters                           | Key Number                                                                 |
|------------------------------|------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Ratchada / Rama 9 / Bang Sue | Transit-driven launches, weak absorption | 15,000+ units launched 2018–2020; absorption still lagging commuter demand |

# 1. Short-Term Rental Market

## Headline Metrics (AirDNA, updated August 25, 2026)

| Metric                        | Bangkok (TTM to Jul 2026) | YoY Change                                                  |
|-------------------------------|---------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|
| Active listings               | 16,437                    | -45.3%                                                      |
| Avg. annual revenue / listing | \$12.5K                   | +138.2%                                                     |
| Occupancy                     | 66%                       | +30.2%                                                      |
| Average daily rate (ADR)      | \$56                      | -17.2%                                                      |
| RevPAR                        | \$37                      | +19.3%                                                      |
| AirDNA Market Score           | 97 / 100                  | Demand 73, Seasonality 96, Revenue growth 64, Regulation 71 |

### Reading the Market Score

Bangkok's 97/100 Market Score sits far above Phuket's 64/100, despite Bangkok's absolute revenue and RevPAR being much lower. The gap is almost entirely the Seasonality subscore (96 vs. 52): Bangkok's demand is consistent year-round rather than concentrated in a high season, which the score rewards independently of income level. Read it as "stable demand," not "higher-earning market."

### Listing Composition

74.4% of Bangkok's 14,461 active AirROI-tracked rentals are entire home/apartment listings — the market is dominated by whole-unit condo listings, which is precisely the segment most exposed under the Hotel Act (see Section 2).

## 2. The Regulatory Reality

The same national law governs Bangkok as Phuket: Thailand's Hotel Act B.E. 2547 (2004) classifies any paid stay under 30 days as a hotel business, regardless of property type. Bangkok's difference is in mix and enforcement style, not in the underlying law.

| Structure                                       | Legal Status                                                   | Requirement                                                                                 |
|-------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Condo, stay under 30 days                       | Illegal without a hotel licence (rarely obtainable for condos) | Hotel Act B.E. 2547, Sections 15 & 59                                                       |
| Condo, stay 30 days or more                     | Legal                                                          | Standard residential lease; no licence needed                                               |
| Licensed serviced apartment / branded residence | Legal for daily-rate income                                    | Building-level hotel or serviced-apartment licence held by the operator, not the unit owner |
| Any structure, foreign guests                   | Separate obligation regardless of the above                    | TM30 filing; fine of THB 800–2,000 per unreported guest                                     |

### Penalties

- Operating without a licence: up to 1 year imprisonment, an initial fine of THB 20,000, plus THB 10,000 for every additional day the violation continues.
- A documented 2025 sweep in Bangkok's Pratunam and Sukhumvit districts used undercover bookings — officials posed as guests, booked condo units on Airbnb, then identified themselves on arrival — covering roughly 191 rooms across several buildings in one operation.

### Enforcement Style

Bangkok's enforcement is Hotel-Act-led and concentrated in named tourist corridors, versus Phuket's joint-immigration model. Multi-agency data sharing between the Revenue Department, Immigration Bureau, and Ministry of Interior now cross-references tax filings, TM30 reports, and business registrations — a discrepancy in any one of these can trigger a flag independently of the others.

### What This Means for a Bangkok Airbnb Business

Because Bangkok has almost no villa stock, the exemption route that partially legalizes Phuket's STR market has no real analog here. A daily-rate condo model is not compliant. The two paths to legal short-stay income are 30-day-plus leasing, or operating within a licensed serviced-apartment or branded-residence structure that holds the hotel licence at the building level.

### 3. Real Estate Market

| Metric                                          | Value                                           |
|-------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|
| Central district avg. condo price / sqm (2026)  | THB 130,000–150,000 (matching late-2019 levels) |
| New-launch avg. price / sqm, H1 2026            | THB 120,364 (+9.4% vs. end-2025's THB 110,000)  |
| Downtown Grade A asking price (CBRE forecast)   | ~THB 315,000 / sqm                              |
| Cumulative take-up rate, Q1 2026                | 71.7% (+2.64% YoY)                              |
| New supply forecast, full-year 2026             | ~20,000 units (Colliers)                        |
| Share of new units priced under THB 100,000/sqm | 80.3%                                           |
| Unsold condo inventory, Greater Bangkok         | ~58,000 units                                   |
| Luxury resale time-on-market                    | 180–240 days (vs. 90–120 days in 2021)          |

Source: Colliers Thailand Q1 2026 Bangkok Condominium Market report, Bangkok Post/Cushman & Wakefield, CBRE Thailand.

#### Interpretation

This is a two-speed market. Downtown and prime stock absorbs fast — CBRE puts ready-to-move-in downtown condos at a ~93% sales rate — while the unsold overhang concentrates in outer-ring and fringe locations (Bang Na, Lat Krabang, outer Sukhumvit, Bang Sue/Lat Phrao extensions). Buyer leverage from the oversupply headline is real in mid-market and fringe stock, but it does not extend to core downtown product, where developers are pushing prices toward pre-pandemic highs.

## 4. Foreign Ownership & Visa Landscape

The national ownership framework is identical to Phuket's: 49% freehold condo quota, no foreign land ownership, 30-year leasehold as the enforceable ceiling. Bangkok's buyer profile and visa mechanics differ in emphasis.

| Metric                                                    | Value                                                                                                                                 |
|-----------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Foreign share of new-project buyers                       | More than 25%                                                                                                                         |
| Bangkok's share of all foreign condo transfers nationally | 43% (REIC) — the largest single foreign-buyer market in the country by volume                                                         |
| Key foreign buyer markets                                 | Taiwan and Singapore prominent; many families buying for children in Bangkok international schools                                    |
| Property visa (national)                                  | THB 3M freehold condo, or THB 85,000/month lease, or a 3-year lease worth ~THB 3.06M, qualifies for a renewable 1-year long-stay visa |
| Bangkok-specific eligibility note                         | For this visa pathway, Bangkok-area condo transfers must be registered at the Land Office on or after October 1, 2020                 |

### Interpretation

Bangkok's foreign-buyer base is more residency- and lifestyle-driven than Phuket's STR-focused buyer profile — families and long-stay professionals rather than short-term-rental investors. That is consistent with a market whose structural strength is liquidity and volume, not STR yield.

## 5. Unit Economics (Illustrative)

Because Bangkok's stock is condo-dominated, the realistic comparison is not villa-vs-condo but compliant-vs-non-compliant condo operation — which makes the risk-adjusted trade-off explicit.

|                                 | Compliant condo (30-day+ lease)                   | Non-compliant condo (daily STR)                                                                                                        |
|---------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Typical entry price, mid-market | \$75K–\$170K (THB 72,000–150,000/sqm, ~50–70 sqm) | Same underlying property                                                                                                               |
| Gross yield                     | 4–6%                                              | ~7–9% before costs, based on AirDNA's \$56 ADR × 66% occupancy<br>→ ~\$13.5K/yr on a mid-market unit                                   |
| Legal status                    | Fully compliant                                   | Illegal under the Hotel Act                                                                                                            |
| Penalty exposure                | None                                              | Up to 1 year imprisonment, THB 20,000 initial fine, THB 10,000/day continuing, plus TM30 fines per guest                               |
| Detection risk (2026)           | None                                              | Rising — data-driven cross-referencing of tax, TM30, and platform listings; undercover-booking sweeps documented in Sukhumvit/Pratunam |
| Resale exposure                 | None                                              | A logged short-stay dispute or bylaw fine surfaces in a buyer's juristic-person due diligence and discounts or kills resale            |

### Interpretation

On paper, the daily-STR condo model outyields the compliant long-let model by roughly two to three points of gross yield — which is exactly why owners keep doing it, and exactly why enforcement keeps escalating. Once penalty exposure and resale contamination are priced in, the risk-adjusted return favors the compliant model unless the property sits inside a licensed serviced-apartment or hotel structure.

## 6. Demand Drivers

| Metric                                               | Value                                                        |
|------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|
| Thailand international arrivals, 2025                | 32.97M (–7.23% YoY, first annual decline since the pandemic) |
| Thailand international arrivals, 2026                | TAT target 33M; YTD through August down ~3.2%                |
| Bangkok visitor gateway volume                       | ~22M visitors/year pass through Bangkok                      |
| Long-haul arrivals (Europe, UK, US, Australia), 2025 | 10.8M (+10.6%, record high)                                  |

### Interpretation

Bangkok functions primarily as a transit and gateway market rather than a destination-duration market. Much of its STR demand is short-stopover, business, or medical tourism — Thailand runs 61 JCI-accredited hospitals, concentrated in Bangkok — rather than the long-haul leisure staying that is lengthening Phuket's guest mix. That favors shorter, higher-turnover stays exactly where compliant options (30-day+ leasing) are weakest.

## 7. Risk Factors & Mitigation

| Risk                                                  | Impact                                                                    | Mitigation                                                                                                         |
|-------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Daily STR in condos (74% of current listings)         | Criminal penalty, fines, resale contamination                             | Convert to a 30-day+ minimum stay, or exit the STR model entirely                                                  |
| Enforcement concentrated exactly where ADR is highest | Highest-yield zones (Sukhumvit corridor) carry the highest detection risk | Underwrite STR economics only where a licensed serviced-apartment or hotel structure is available                  |
| Oversupply overhang (~58,000 unsold units)            | Price and liquidity risk in fringe locations                              | Buy in zones with the ~93% ready-to-move absorption rate (downtown/prime), not fringe transit-corridor stock       |
| Chinese buyer segment still ~40% below 2018–19 peak   | Reduced foreign-buyer demand floor versus historical levels               | Underwrite to the current foreign-buyer base (Taiwan, Singapore, long-stay families), not a Chinese-buyer recovery |
| Nominee / company-structure exposure                  | Same nationwide crackdown risk as Phuket                                  | Use foreign-quota freehold only; avoid company structures holding property for a foreign principal                 |

## Closing Note

Bangkok is not a short-term-rental play right now. It is a market digesting its own condo oversupply while running the same enforcement regime as Phuket, but with no villa or exemption safety valve. The listing-count and revenue-per-listing moves mirror Phuket's — fewer listings, each earning more — which is compliance rationing, not demand growth.

The defensible model is buying downtown or prime, fast-absorbing stock at current pre-pandemic-recovery pricing and letting it long-term (30-day+), rather than chasing the Sukhumvit STR ADR that also carries Bangkok's heaviest enforcement. A licensed serviced-apartment structure is the only route to legal daily-rate income at scale.

If the goal is a management business rather than direct ownership, Bangkok's opportunity is helping condo owners convert to compliant 30-day+ operations and licensed structures — not running unlicensed daily-turn units through the current enforcement cycle.

*Data sources: AirDNA (short-term rental performance, updated August 2026), AirROI (listing composition, 2026), Colliers Thailand and CBRE Thailand (real estate pricing and supply), Cushman & Wakefield, Bangkok Post, and Thai legal counsel publications (regulatory and visa detail), as cited throughout. STR revenue and occupancy figures are market averages and will vary materially by property — treat them as a starting benchmark, not a specific-property forecast.*